



<Code Club JUSL/>



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Salesforce

Futureforce AI Challenge – Internship Acceptance Guide

A complete guide for aspiring interns

Student's Experience & Suggestions

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Name	Joyosmit Pal
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Year of Grad.	2027

Experience

The entire process was done via **Futureforce AI Challenge (hackathon)**

OA -> 3 DSA questions were asked of **2 LC medium** and **1 LC hard** level. **2 of them were of graphs along with binary search** and the other one was **2 pointer on array**. From what I could gather, I managed to pass all test cases for all 3 questions and cleared the OA.

Virtual interview -> It was held on Google Meet. The interviewer introduced himself and then asked me to introduce myself. After that he pasted a DSA question into a code-sharing website (cant remember the name).

This was the question <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/dsa/count-pairs-from-a-given-array-whose-sum-lies-from-a-given-range/>

I first gave the brute-force method and then optimised it using binary search. After he was satisfied with my approach he asked me to code it and I did.

The next question I was asked was **"Implement queue using stacks"**. It was pretty easy and I explained the idea on whiteboard. After that he asked about the **freelancing project I had mentioned on my resume**, and then asked whether I had any questions. I asked about work-life balance at Salesforce and about the hackathon.

Physical interview -> It was held at Salesforce Office in Hyderabad the day after the hackathon ended. This was a hiring manager round.

At first he introduced himself, then asked me to introduce myself. **He asked about my projects** and what problem they solved (I had a blockchain-based full-stack project). Then he asked if I had to pitch my project to a board of investors after 1 year of having the project in production, what metrics could I use to justify the success of my project. Then I was asked what all issues I faced when building it. I mainly spoke about deployment issues and running out of tokens for testing on testnet. Then I was asked **"Why Salesforce?"**. Then I was asked a **puzzle** which I could partially solve. After that I was asked to give just **the idea, not the**

code for LRU cache. Then he asked if I had any questions. I asked about what kind of work interns are generally assigned, what the career trajectory is at Salesforce and what did my interviewer's team do (he was a Engineering Manager).

Prep. Tips

- Prepare Leetcode mediums and hards, especially graphs
- When explaining to the interviewer your approach or coding it out, do not be silent. Keep telling why you are doing what you are doing.
- Dry run your code before hitting "Run" and explain your thought process along the way.
- When the interviewer gives some hint, use it. It gives a good impression if you can follow directions and work your way upon that.

Addit. Notes

- When asked if you have any questions, never say I don't. Always ask something to show you are interested in joining them.
- Keep an answer ready for "Why you want to join us?"

Best of luck

✓ **Selected**

Name	Sayan Dutta
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Year of Grad.	2027

Experience

Salesforce has multiple events throughout the year to hire AMTS interns and I was a part of the **FutureForce AI challenge**

OA: It was of **100 minutes** and we had **3 problems** to solve, the first question was on the **concept of prefix sum in a circular array**. I struggled with this a lot as I was confused by the circular indexing and all, and actually wrote a working dp solution instead. The second question was of **binary search on trees, the question itself was a pretty standard one (similar to leetcode 3419. Minimize the Maximum Edge Weight of Graph)** so had no problem solving it. The third question had the weird statement, I was staring at the screen for 10 minutes to decode the question itself. I don't remember it properly **but It was also based on graph where for every connected component we had a initial leader assigned for that component and in every query we delete some edges, after removing the edges, if the leader of the component is removed, then the next leader will be minimum of remaining elements of that component**, I solved it by storing a set for each connected component and removing elements during queries while keeping track of the leaders. The questions were not themselves that hard but the statements made them bit difficult. overall I was able to solve all 3 questions and funny enough i got a rejection mail from them 1 week later and then surprisingly got my interview scheduled 2 weeks after the OA

Online Interview : It was a straight forward one, the interviewer didn't even asked me to introduce myself and didn't gave his introduction as well. He shared a codepair link where I had to code and explained the problem, **given a string S of integers find the next greater string which can be created from it by using only the digits available in the current string**. Initially i was not able to understand the problem well in the first go but when the interviewer explained an example, I understood that it was basically the question **next permutation** from leetcode, I explained the optimal solution properly to him and after that he asked me to code it up. After i was done coding, the interviewer tested the code on few test cases and corrected my code which was missing an edge case. Then he asked me questions on **oops about abstract classes and polymorphism (some of my friends were even asked from OS and DBMS but in my case he only asked me from oops)**. the interview was over in around 25 minutes and after a month i got to know that i am selected for the onsite hackathon + interview

Hackathon : It was in the salesforce office, Hyderabad. Although It didn't directly affected our selection, but **reviews about every candidate was taken from the mentors of each group during the hackathon**. It was a 3 day event, on the first day it was the opening ceremony followed by the 12 hour hackathon on the next day, and the final day was for interviews. We were told that the round would be a hr round with some technical aspects but it varied a lot. For me the interviewer took a technical + hr round (PS. The interviewer also got to know that he would be interviewing me like 2 minutes before). We both introduced ourselves, then the interviewer gave the question, **it was leetcode 911. Online Election, just a bit modified where only 2 voters exist instead of n voters**. He left some gap in the question intentionally which was for me to figure out. I explained my solution with prefix sums using 2 prefix arrays for the two voters and binary search and he told me to write the solution in a paper, after that I was asked the time and space complexity of the solution and a follow up if i can do it using only one prefix array, and then asked if i can do it without using prefix array (i was still allowed to use extra space, just not the prefix array itself). I answered both of them and then proceeded to the **behavioral round**. He asked me to explain a time when I was working in a team and had some issues working in there with other teammates, and what I did or what should have been done by me to resolve the issue. Next he asked me if it ever happened that I proposed a idea for a hackathon and my teammates agreed on that idea and worked on it. The interview concluded with a bit of cultural discussion about the work life balance in salesforce and it's goal as a company

Prep. Tips

For clearing OA, I recommend completing the striver A2Z ds&A sheet and practicing questions of graphs, dp from leetcode contests. Specifically they ask a lot of binary search questions so you need to have a good grip at it. For the interviews, prepare core subjects well (oops, os, dbms) and revise the projects you have mentioned in the resume.

Addit. Notes

Salesforce values their culture very much and you need to be well aware of the terms used like Ohana , 5 core values, Philanthropy (1-1-1 Model) etc. although I was not asked about these a lot ,some of my friends where only asked about the culture and how they see themselves as a fit for this company.

✓ **Selected**
